

Import Data Using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)

ServiceNow Data Import Documentation

Team ID	SWTID-2026-5675
Document Type	Technical / Project Documentation
Topic	Import Data Using Transform Maps from Spreadsheet
Platform	ServiceNow

1. Project Description

This document explains how to import records from a spreadsheet into ServiceNow by using an Import Set and Transform Map. The process allows spreadsheet data to be loaded into a staging table, mapped to the required target table fields, transformed when necessary, and finally inserted or updated in the target ServiceNow table.

2. Objective

The main objective is to demonstrate a simple and controlled method for importing spreadsheet data into ServiceNow.

Key objectives:

- Prepare spreadsheet data in a structured format.
- Upload the spreadsheet into ServiceNow.
- Create an Import Set Table to temporarily hold the imported records.
- Create a Transform Map between the source and target tables.
- Map spreadsheet columns to ServiceNow target fields.
- Run the transformation and verify the imported records.

3. Prerequisites

- ServiceNow instance with permission to perform data imports.
- A spreadsheet file in a supported format such as Excel (.xlsx) or CSV.
- Required target table and fields should already be available.
- Basic knowledge of ServiceNow tables, Import Sets, and Transform Maps.

4. Sample Spreadsheet Structure

The spreadsheet should contain column headers that represent the data to be imported. For example:

Name	Email	Department	Phone
------	-------	------------	-------

Arun Kumar	arun@example.com	IT	9876543210
Priya S	priya@example.com	HR	9876543211
Kavin R	kavin@example.com	Finance	9876543212

5. Import Data Workflow

Spreadsheet → Import Set → Import Set Table → Transform Map → Field Mapping → Transform → Target Table

The workflow separates the uploaded source data from the final target records. This makes the import process easier to validate and control.

6. Procedure

Step 1 – Prepare the Spreadsheet

Create the spreadsheet with clear column headers and valid values. Remove unnecessary blank rows and make sure each column contains consistent data.

Step 2 – Open the Import Set / Import Tool

In ServiceNow, open the data import functionality and select the option to import data. Choose the prepared spreadsheet file as the data source.

Step 3 – Upload the Spreadsheet

Select the Excel or CSV file and start the import. ServiceNow reads the spreadsheet and creates or uses an Import Set Table to hold the source records.

Step 4 – Select the Target Table

Choose the ServiceNow table where the imported records should finally be stored. The target table should contain the fields required by the project.

Step 5 – Create the Transform Map

Create a Transform Map between the Import Set Table and the target table. The Transform Map defines how source fields are transferred to target fields.

Step 6 – Configure Field Mapping

Map each spreadsheet column to the corresponding target-table field. For example, Name can be mapped to Name, Email to Email, and Department to Department.

Step 7 – Configure Coalesce if Required

A coalesce field can be used as a unique matching field when the requirement is to update an existing record instead of creating a duplicate record. This should be selected only when appropriate for the target data.

Step 8 – Run Transform

Run the transformation after confirming the field mappings. ServiceNow processes the Import Set records and applies the Transform Map to create or update records in the target table.

Step 9 – Verify the Result

Open the target table and check the imported records. Verify important fields such as name, email, department, and phone. Also review the import/transform logs for rejected or failed records.

7. Transform Map Components

Component	Purpose
Import Set Table	Temporary/staging table that stores the spreadsheet data.
Target Table	Final ServiceNow table where records are created or updated.
Transform Map	Defines the relationship and transformation between source and target data.
Field Map	Maps individual source columns to target fields.
Coalesce	Helps identify an existing record for update and can prevent duplicates.
Transform Scripts	Optional scripts used when custom data transformation is required.

8. Field Mapping Example

Spreadsheet Column	Target Field	Mapping
Name	Name	Direct
Email	Email	Direct
Department	Department	Direct
Phone	Phone	Direct

9. Validation and Error Handling

- Check that the spreadsheet headers match the expected source fields.
- Verify mandatory target fields before running the transformation.
- Check the Transform History and import logs after execution.
- Correct invalid or missing source data and re-run the import when required.
- Use coalesce carefully to avoid unwanted duplicate or updated records.

10. Expected Result

After a successful transformation, the spreadsheet records should appear in the selected ServiceNow target table with the correct field values. The import and transform results should show the number of records processed successfully and identify any records that failed.

11. Advantages

- Reduces manual data entry.
- Supports bulk record creation and updates.
- Provides field-level mapping between source and target data.
- Allows validation and transformation before data reaches the target table.
- Makes repeated spreadsheet imports easier to manage.

12. Conclusion

Importing spreadsheet data through ServiceNow Import Sets and Transform Maps provides a structured way to move external data into ServiceNow. The process includes preparing the spreadsheet, loading the data into an Import Set Table, creating a Transform Map, mapping fields, running the transformation, and verifying the final records. This approach helps maintain data consistency and reduces manual effort.

Team ID: SWTID-2026-5675